states, too. This happened in 1950 with the setting up of the Planning Commission.

The Board, in its Report of January 1947, emphatically expressed the opinion that the "proper development of large-scale industries can only take place if political units, whether in the provinces or states, agree to work in accordance with a common plan."[15] This suggestion worked as a great influence on the planning process of independent India as it always tried to give unifying nature to development planning. But, this process also induced a serious tendency of centralisation in the Indian planning to which a number of states were to pose objections and therely straining the centre-state relations, time and again.[16] However, the political leadership right since 1920s was very conscious of the need for decentralised planning in the country.[17]

The Bombay Plan

Bombay Plan was the popular title of 'A Plan of Economic Development for India' which was prepared by a cross-section of India's leading capitalists. The eight capitalists involved in this plan were Purshotamdas Thakurdas, J.R.D. Tata, G.D. Birla, Lala Sri Ram, Kasturbhai Lalbhai, A.D. Shroff, Avdeshir Dalal and John Mathai.[18] The Plan was published in 1944–45. Out of these eight industrialists, Purshotamdas Thakurdas was one among the 15 members of the National Planning Committee (1938)[19]. Rest three J.R.D. Tata, G.D. Birla and Lala Sri Ram, were the members of the sub-committees (29 in total) of the National Planning Committee.[20]

The popular sentiments regarding the need of planning and criss-cross of memberships between the NPC and the Bombay Plan club made possible some clear-cut agreements between these two major plans which ultimately went to mould the very shape of the Indian economy after independence. We may have a look at some of the very important agreements:[21]

(i) A basic agreement on the issue of the ***agrarian restructuring—*** abolition of all intermediaries (i.e Zamindari Abolition), minimum wages, guarantee of minimum or fair prices to agricultural producers, cooperatives, credit and marketing supports.